

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #2362

Name
Jedidiah Thompson
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Gender
Male
City, state, and country of residence
Stanford, CA, USA
Nationality
USA
When did or will you finish your PhD?
Spring 2023
University Education
PhD in Physics, Stanford University, expected spring 2023 B.S. in Physics, Yale University, June 2017
What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?
I have always been fascinated by the natural world, and I believe that science holds many of the keys for understanding it. I also, however, believe that working scientists have an ethical duty to help spread this understanding to the wider public. I have really enjoyed teaching in the university environment, but spending nearly all my time in such an environment has left me with a perspective narrower than what I would like. My research is quite removed from the real world, and so I find it very meaningful and fulfilling to give back something concrete to society. I am currently applying to postdoctoral positions, but I am also reevaluating whether I want to stay in academia or move to a more teaching- or outreach-focused role. I'm applying to be a Science Corps fellow in order to get a short taste of what that side of things might look like and help me make a more well-informed decision about my future. I'm not sure whether I will stay in academia, but I know that regardless I want to structure my life in a way that helps the world, and I believe the Science Corps is doing that!
In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

I have extensive teaching experience, both in person and online. This includes being a teaching assistant for both introductory and graduate level courses at Stanford, being a laboratory assistant for the advanced physics lab at Yale University, and teaching for several programs targeting high school students. For the past year and a half, I have been a mentor for the Crimson Research Institute, where I have guided high school students in researching an advanced physics topic, and while I was at Yale I taught math and physics for two different programs for incoming freshmen with weak STEM backgrounds.

Outside of teaching, I also have outreach experience. I volunteered with Yale Splash to teach a course on particle physics, I have hosted two different local radio shows focusing primarily on physics and math, and I was a 2019-2020 science envoy for Wonderfest, a SF bay area science outreach organization.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

At the moment I am applying for postdoctoral positions in theoretical physics, and I currently intend to continue within an academic environment (i.e. remain an academic scientist), however I am generally frustrated with how poorly most academics interface with the wider public, and I want to chart a course for myself that successfully gives back to the wider community. This will likely involve ongoing efforts in science outreach and communication as well as teaching, but I have not yet ruled out the possibility that I will leave academia entirely and turn to a fully teaching- or outreach-focused profession.

To that end, in the near-term future I expect to take a postdoctoral position that will start roughly in September 2023, but in the long-term future I remain fairly agnostic. I hope that by spending some time as a Science Corps fellow I can get a better sense for the joys and challenges of a professional career focused more on education and outreach and be in a better place to make an informed decision about my future.

CV/Resume

 [CV.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

I will be available from roughly June to September of 2023, and I would be most enthusiastic about working in Tangier as I have intermediate fluency in French. In descending order, my choice of the other sites is: Aavishkaar, Central Visayan Institute Foundation, and City University.